



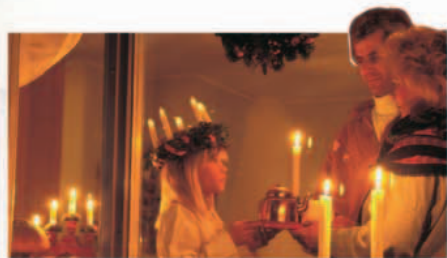
Having a good time

Most Europeans work fixed and quite long hours, and all look forward to the holidays that dot their calendar. As well as major religious celebrations like Christmas, each country and region holds local festivals and events. Some holidays and events are ancient in origin, while others, such as sports tournaments, are more recent inventions but just as popular.



SPLAT!

The tomato festival held near Valencia in Spain each year was only recently instituted. It owes its popularity to being so much fun.



FESTIVAL OF LIGHT

Celebrated in deepest midwinter in Sweden and Norway, St. Lucia's Day helps to cheer people up during the darkest part of the year.



CARNIVAL

The Venice Carnival is an old tradition that allows people to disguise themselves with masks and have a wild time.



PASSION FOR SPORTS

Soccer matches and other sports events have, to some extent, replaced religion in arousing people's passionate involvement. Sports stadiums, especially when hosting soccer games, are one of the few public places where people cheer, laugh, and even cry.

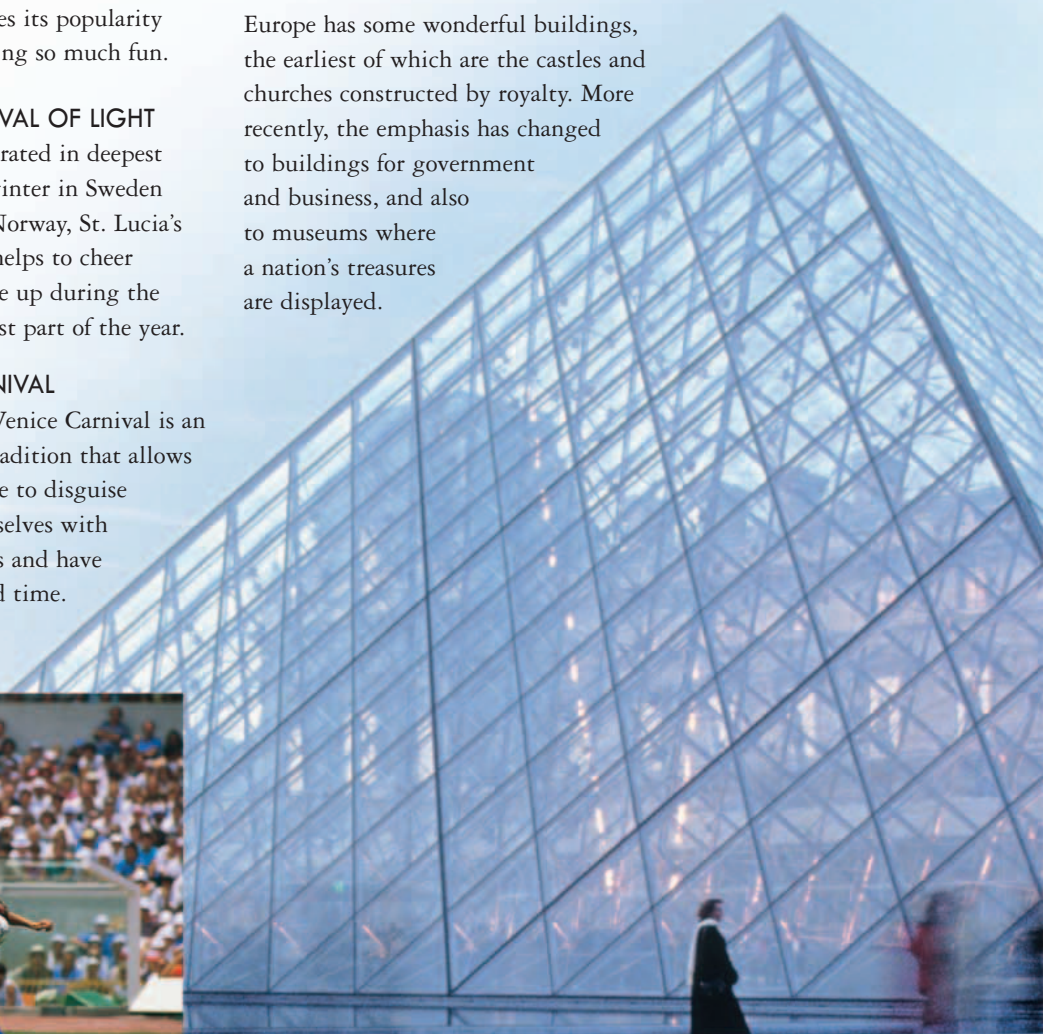


A NIGHT OUT

Most European cities have concert halls, opera houses, and theaters where formal, well-rehearsed performances of music, dance, or plays are put on. Spectators, like those at the ballet, must pay to watch; and unlike in other cultures, they do not participate.

FANTASTIC CONSTRUCTIONS

Europe has some wonderful buildings, the earliest of which are the castles and churches constructed by royalty. More recently, the emphasis has changed to buildings for government and business, and also to museums where a nation's treasures are displayed.



Museums like the Louvre in Paris enable large numbers of people to view works of art and artifacts that they do not personally own.